She later joined a leading domestic airline as a stewardess. Her story did not end there. She took lessons in flying and joined as a pilot in the airline. The TPSWT paid for all her education and training, giving wings to her dreams.

Besides, the trust extended the family other financial assistance and a pension. Anjali says, ‘Tata sir gave us hope’, taught her to stand on her feet, treated her like a ‘family member’. She concludes, ‘I have not seen Bhagwan. There is a god. How can a god be better than this?’ Then she pleads, choking with emotion, ‘I’m longing to see my god. Just once to touch his feet, at least once, of the man who gave me my house back.’

Some thirty-five of those directly affected or their family members were given skills training at the Taj Lands End in Bandra West. Thereafter, they were employed in various departments of the Taj hotels, say Manoj Thakur and Mohammed Ansari, who were both shot near Leopold Café. Today, both are working in the F&B department of the Taj President. Their children’s education is also being covered by the trust. Ansari, who had had virtually no education, proudly says that he now has the expertise to identify the nearly two dozen types of various wine glasses, cutlery and crockery that is used for regular service at the hotel. He works in the Italian restaurant and says that now he can talk confidently even with VIPs. ‘I got it at the Taj,’ he says with pride in his eyes.

Another person who benefited enormously was a janitor, Karuna, who works at GT Hospital, Mumbai. Her husband, twenty-nine-year-old Waghela, was having his dinner on 26 November at around 9.30 p.m. when Ajmal Kasab, one of the terrorists, knocked at the door of their tiny apartment. Waghela opened the door and the gun-wielding man asked for water twice. After quenching his thirst, he sprayed Waghela with bullets from his AK-47 assault rifle, killing him instantly. His four-year-old son escaped into the bathroom when Kasab raised the rifle to shoot him.

The TPSWT reached out to Karuna after learning about the incident. The help the trust extended involved various forms of financial assistance, including the fees for her three children. The son who witnessed the shooting stopped studying after Class Nine as he was unable to fully recover from the shock of his father being gunned down in front of him. Karuna also suffers from depression and is under medication. But she told me as she was leaving: ‘When you meet Tata sir, say thank you to him. We ate food because of him.’